

and also make money from trading in other stocks. Of course, my name would not figure anywhere officially.

“He is willing to offer 25 per cent of the profits and a free hand; I think that is good. If you make outsized profits, the share can be further negotiated,’ GB said.

‘Tell me that you have not already committed to him,’ I said.

He grinned.

‘I have not committed, but I think this deal is a good way for you to stay in the market and at the same time keep a low profile. And you don’t have to be bound to him forever. Should something bigger come up, you are free to pursue it. Think about it,’ GB said.

The offer made sense. I needed to stay in the game till I could figure out what to do. There were plenty of offers of a ‘consultancy’ nature, but this was something that would help me stay agile as a trader. Trading is something I have enjoyed and wanted to do till I felt the urge to do something else.

I began my assignment the following week. The promoter was true to his word, and I had a free run in deciding my trading strategies. He never haggled when it came to sharing profits, and I managed to meet his expectations, thanks to a fairly buoyant market riding the BJP’s thumping win in the general elections.

Sometime during the year, I happened to renew contact with Dipesh, a close friend of mine from my schooldays. Dipesh, or Dipya, as we used to call him, had returned from Dubai for good two years ago and was now working for a management consultancy. During our conversation, I learnt that he had been bitten by the stock market bug after having got lucky with a few investments.

‘I have been regularly trading in small stocks for nearly a year now, and have made decent money,’ he said.

‘Good for you, Dipya, but invest the profits from trading wisely, that is the only way to grow your wealth,’ I said.

‘Yes, I will. But first I need to make some more money through trading. I think I am getting a good idea of how the market works. In a few months, I should be making money on a more regular basis,’ he said.

‘That thinking has been the undoing of many big players in the past,’ I told him as diplomatically as possible, actually meaning to tell him that he should not confuse luck for skill.